

Back up important files and folders

Tucked away within Vista is a built-in backup utility. Here's how to take advantage of it

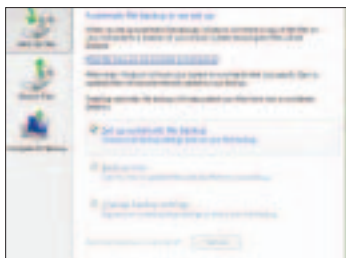
Personal files are often the most valuable items stored on the hard disk and are hard to replace in case they are corrupted. It is highly recommended to backup your data.

Vista Home Premium includes everything needed to get started. Anyone who is working with a copy of Windows Vista Ultimate has access to an additional backup tool in the form of Complete PC Backup. Rather than just backing up personal files and folders, this tool makes it possible to back up the entire contents of your hard drive, including the programs that are installed and any settings that have been put in place.

Whichever version of Vista you have, it is worth familiarising yourself with its backup utility as it provides a handy means of safeguarding data.

Step 1

Launch the backup tool by going to Start > All Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Backup Status and Configuration. Ensure you are in the backup section of the program by clicking the Back Up Files link on the left of the screen. In the case of



Vista Home Premium, Back Up Files and Restore Files options will be available, while Vista Ultimate adds Complete PC Backup. Assuming this is the first backup to have been created in this way, Windows should indicate that an 'automatic backup file is not yet set'. Click the button labelled 'Set up automatic file backup' and then click Continue when the User Account Control dialogue box appears.